

See also: Vattel's *The Law of Nations* 108 ■ The Napoleonic Code 130–131 ■ The European Convention on Human Rights 230–233 ■ The Helsinki Treaty 242–243 ■ *Google Spain v. AEPD and Mario Costeja González* 308–309

cooperation. The stated purpose of the CoE was then (and remains today) to uphold human rights, democracy, and the rule of law in Europe. The CoE now has a total of 47 member states.

The CoE is sometimes confused with the EU, and it has the same flag and anthem. However, the CoE has no power to make laws, though it does have the power to enforce agreements made by European states. Its emphasis is on the rights of European citizens, and it has spawned many subsidiary organizations and Conventions that focus on specific areas. Notable among these are the European Convention on Human Rights (ECHR), the European Committee for the Prevention of Torture (CPT), and the CoE Convention on the Protection of Children from Sexual Exploitation and Sexual Abuse. Crucially, in 1959, the CoE set up the European Court of Human Rights (ECtHR), which enforces the ECHR.

Economic ties

Among the subjects discussed by the CoE in its early days was the possibility of greater economic

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[When] nations and men
accept the same rules ... their
behavior toward each other
changes. This is the process
of civilization itself.

Jean Monnet
A Ferment of Change, 1962

and political integration of member countries. Various ideas were put forward, but none could secure majority support.

In 1945, however, French political economist Jean Monnet had urged France to take over Germany's coal-producing regions in the districts of the Ruhr and the Saar to weaken Germany's industrial might and help France's postwar economic recovery. The Monnet Plan was adopted: with US backing, in 1947, the Saar became a French protectorate, and in 1949,

the Ruhr Agreement was imposed on western Germany, allowing the US, the UK, France, and the Benelux countries (Belgium, the Netherlands, and Luxembourg) to take control of the Ruhr's coal mines. This was a precondition for the establishment of the Federal Republic of Germany, which was formed by the merger of the western sectors of Allied-controlled Germany. (Soon after, the eastern sector became the Soviet-dominated German Democratic Republic.)

Tensions between former enemies France and West Germany over control of the Saarland spurred Monnet on with his vision of an integrated European community. In 1950, in a declaration drafted partly by Monnet, French foreign minister Robert Schuman proposed a plan to combine all French and German coal and steel production into a common market, governed by a single High Authority (HA)—a »

The Saar River was a key industrial corridor in the 1950s, connecting the Saarland coalfields with Saarbrücken, the regional capital city. Canals form links to France and to the Netherlands.

